FaujPrep

Initial Interview 3: Current Affairs and General Awareness

Build understanding, not a list of headlines

Current-affairs questions can change quickly, and no private list can guarantee what an interviewer will ask. Build a small, reliable daily habit using reputable news outlets and official sources for statistics, policies, and statements. Check publication dates; old facts may no longer be current.

A 20-minute daily routine

1. Read one major national story and one international story.
2. For each, write a one-sentence summary in your own words.
3. Note the key people or institutions, location, and date.
4. Record why the issue matters and one unresolved question.
5. Verify hard numbers or official decisions against a primary source where available.

For Pakistan-related topics, understand the basic roles of public institutions and how a policy or event affects citizens. For defence and international affairs, learn the relevant geography, parties, timeline, and stated positions. Avoid treating social-media claims as verified facts.

The "what, why, so what" answer

- What happened? State the verified event and when it occurred.
- Why did it happen? Give the main context without presenting speculation as fact.
- So what? Explain the likely impact and what remains uncertain.

If asked for an opinion, separate facts from your view. Offer a reason, acknowledge a credible counterpoint, and avoid inflammatory or sweeping statements. A balanced answer can be decisive without being dogmatic.

Example: handle an opinion and its counter-question

Suppose you are asked about inflation. A structured answer could be: "Inflation means a general rise in prices, which reduces what a household can buy with the same income. Its causes can include several factors, so I would check current data before naming the main cause. It affects families differently, especially those with fixed incomes. Policy choices can reduce some pressures but may create trade-offs."

Interviewer: "So should the government simply raise salaries?"

Candidate: "That can help some workers, but if price increases continue, the gain may be temporary, and not every worker receives the same adjustment. I would compare targeted support with measures addressing supply and price stability; the right choice depends on current evidence and the groups affected."

The lesson is not to memorise this opinion. It is to define the issue, avoid an unsupported single-cause

claim, acknowledge a trade-off, and explain what information would improve your view.

Build a review sheet

Keep one page per week, not a huge notebook. Use headings such as Pakistan, region, world, economy, science/technology, and defence. Include only items you can explain. Remove outdated details instead of memorising them indefinitely.

Practise aloud

Choose one story and explain it in 60 seconds to someone who has not read it. Ask them what was unclear. Then answer one follow-up: "What is the evidence?" or "What might be another perspective?" This improves both recall and calm speaking.

Accuracy under pressure

If you are unsure of a date or figure, say that you are not certain and explain what you do know. Do not fabricate a statistic. If the interviewer gives new information, listen and update your answer rather than clinging to a mistaken claim.

Avoid

Do not rely only on viral clips, anonymous forwards, or coaching "sure questions." Do not confuse an opinion with a confirmed event. Do not turn a discussion into a political argument.

Reminder

General awareness supports a conversation; it does not guarantee selection. Check current details close to your interview because events and official guidance change.

Research basis

The ISSB candidate guidelines (https://issb.gov.pk/guidelines) describe clear thinking and composure under stress as desirable qualities. They do not prescribe a current-affairs syllabus for the initial interview; this note offers a general practice method.